

The Dhāraṇī Entitled 'Gazing upon the Heart-Essence and Sacred Pledge of All the Tathāgatas by means of the Radiance of the Uṣṇīṣa's Stainless Light that Enters through Every Opening'

Samantamukhapraveśaraśmivimalośṇīṣaprabhāśasarvatathāgatahṛdayasamayavilokitanā
madhāraṇī · Toh 599 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 599 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Samantamukha praveśaraśmivimalośṇīṣaprabhāśasarvatathāgatahṛdayasamayavilokitanāmadhāraṇī, rendered in Tibetan as "The Dhāraṇī Entitled Gazing upon the Heart-Essence and Sacred Pledge of All the Tathāgatas by means of the Radiance of the Uṣṇīṣa's Stainless Light that Enters through Every Gateway." It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature, a genre concerned with sacred formulas and their associated teachings and ritual power. The text opens with the Blessed One residing in the divine abode of Tuṣita, teaching the Dharma of the six perfections to an vast assembly that includes bodhisattvas, gods of the Long-Life Heaven, and great divine beings such as Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Śiva. It was translated into Tibetan by the master Gyaltsen Zangpo at the great temple of Glorious Tharpa Ling.

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In the Sanskrit language: Samantamukhapraveśaraśmivimalośṇīṣaprabhāśasarvatathāgatahṛdayasamayavilokitanāmadhāraṇī.

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Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One, dwelling in the divine abode of Tuṣita, together with a great assembly of bodhisattvas, a vast gathering of the gods of the Long-Life Heaven, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), and many other divine beings, taught the Dharma of the six perfections to the great multitude gathered around him. This is what he taught:

The perfection of generosity, through which the accumulation of the great stores of merit from giving ripens as the fruit of lordship over a realm as a wheel-turning sovereign, as a rain of the seven precious things, and as the arising of a vast spontaneously accomplished treasure. The perfection of moral discipline, through which the possession of the Tathāgata's teaching, the five higher knowledges, and pure conduct ripens as the fruit of birth as a Brahmā or as a god. The perfection of patience, through which the fruit of being excellently adorned with major marks and minor features as pleasing to behold as the lovely form of a god ripens into maturation. The perfection of diligence, through which the fruit of beginning to exert effort, of taming māra, of liberation from aging and death and from birth, and of going by miraculous birth to a buddha-field ripens into maturation. The perfection of meditative concentration, through which the fruit of attaining billions and hundreds of millions of meditative absorptions such as the courageous-advance absorption and many others ripens into maturation. The perfection of wisdom, through which the fruit of accumulating a great store of wisdom and gnosis and an ocean of learning, along with its ripening as great learning, matures.

Then those divine sons, contemplating and practicing this very gateway of Dharma of the six perfections day and night, also cultivated it on account of its great difficulty.

Now, within that very divine retinue, there was a divine son of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three named Stainless Jewel-Essence. He was attended by ten million divine sons who served as his retinue, was encircled by eighteen thousand divine daughters, and dwelt in a magnificently fashioned celestial palace of divine transformation, built with walls of the seven precious materials, beautifully adorned with parks of many kinds, and graced with ponds made lovely with divine flowers. That divine son, Stainless Jewel-Essence, was together with his foremost divine daughter named Fully Blooming Flower, experiencing great abundance of delight, attached to divine pleasures, and in that palace with four gateways built of the seven precious materials, richly supplied with and intoxicated by the five qualities of sensory desire, he lay down puffed up with pride, arrogant and self-satisfied. Then, around midnight, that divine son fell into sleep, and all the hosts of divine daughters fell silent and likewise lay down to sleep.

In that excellent place there dwelt a chief among the divine yakṣas named Arrow-Face. He roused the divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence and spoke these words: "Hey, Stainless Jewel-Essence, wake up! Wake up! What use is it to be

so fond of sleep and attached to it? What use is it to be habituating yourself to pleasure and remaining in attachment?

What use is it to go on enjoying immeasurable divine pleasures? In just seven days you will meet the hour of death. You will be separated from all divine pleasures and will experience great and terrible suffering. What then will be the good of your splendid palace, that excellent mansion built of seven kinds of precious jewels? Your life will not come back — seek swiftly now a means of rescue.

Having spoken these words, the chief of the divine yakṣas, Arrow-Face, vanished from sight.

Then the divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence, upon hearing those dreadful words, fainted and fell headlong from his bed, crashing to the ground. At that, the whole company of divine daughters shook loose their hair, their ornaments fell away, their garments became disordered, their mouths ran with blood, their lips, palates, throats, and tongues dried up, and they wept and wailed with many thousands of cries, lamenting and calling out in anguish again and again. From vessels of divine jewels they sprinkled cool perfumed water and cool sandalwood water over him. Some clasped him by the neck, some by the hands, some stroked his hair, some held his feet, some grasped his head, and some fainted and fell themselves. Some writhed on the ground like fish out of water, and some twisted as though their bodies were being seared by fire, while others cried out in many lamentations, wailing again and again.

Then the divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence recovered from his faint. Coming back to his senses, he vomited blood, experienced fierce and terrible suffering, breathed out a long and shuddering breath, and stood trembling, swaying like a tree buffeted by the wind. With a heart stricken and shattered by grief, he went straight to where Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods, was to be found. He came before Śakra, touched his feet, and clasped both of them in his hands, saying: "Blessed One, I beg you, protect me! Blessed One, you who are master of the great king of the gods, protect me! Having heard the announcement of the chief of the divine yakṣas, Arrow-Face, I know that in seven days I shall meet the hour of death." And weeping he added: "Contemplate the suffering of the hell-beings, I implore you. Lord of the gods, please grant me, I beg you, a remedy free of fear — a remedy by which my death will not come about through my own doing and by which I will not descend into the lower realms. Lord of the gods, by whatever means possible, I beg you, protect me through

the rite of liberation, that my death may pass away on its own terms."

Then Śakra, the lord of the gods, hearing those words, was filled with deep sorrow at heart, and spoke thus to the divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence: "Divine son, do not be afraid! There is one who can defeat the lord of death, one by whom beings are liberated from the sufferings of hell — the awakened Blessed One, the Teacher of gods and humans in this world, the unsurpassed physician who has gone beyond birth, aging, sickness, death, and sorrow. He is your refuge, your good kinsman and ally, and like a father and mother to you. He is the one who destroys all lower destinies. Let us go swiftly to wherever that guide abides."

Then, at dawn of that very day, Śakra the lord of the gods, the divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence, and many thousands of gods and divine daughters all set out together from the Joyful Heaven (Tuṣita) and went to where the Blessed One was to be found. They arrived in the presence of the Blessed One, bowed their heads to his feet in homage, circumambulated him three times, and stood before him.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One in words of humble supplication, saying: "Blessed One, the divine yakṣa-chief Comet-Face has urged this divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence, and has announced that in seven days, under the parasol, this Stainless Jewel-Essence will fall into the power of the lord of death. Blessed One, what is to be done for him?"

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, having heard the words of Śakra lord of the gods, smiled. As he displayed that smile, rays of light of many hues streamed forth from his face. Those rays of light illumined the great trichiliocosm, the world-realm of the three-thousandfold great thousand worlds. That brilliance of light stirred and roused the dwellings of all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras (half-human beings), great serpents, rākṣasas, and all manner of spirits. Having roused them, the light turned back, circled the Blessed One three times, and then entered through the door of the Blessed One's mouth. No sooner had it entered than the Blessed One declared to Śakra lord of the gods:

"Lord of the gods, hear this: this divine son Stainless Jewel-Essence will in seven days face the terror of the lord of death's door. If he comes to die at that time, he will experience the feelings of the great hells — immense, unbearable suffering, fierce and terrible. First, in the great city of Vārāṇasī, he will be born as a flesh-eating sow with a pig's head, in the mire and filth of a reed-cutter's

cesspit, and there he will eat excrement and urine. Within that very cesspit dwell many billions of creatures, and at all three times of day they will eat the flesh of that sow, leaving nothing but bones. Then, through the force of karma, a body will arise again, and he will survive for seven years. Then he will come to the time of death. After that he will be born in a wilderness as a turtle, in a place where the very name of water is unheard and there is no shade of a tree. Scorched and blistered by the heat of the sun, he will eat grains of sand, and crows will tear at his body, rending it limb from limb. Then again through the force of karma a body will arise and perish, and so it will continue for five full years. Then he will come to the time of death, and will be born as a great fish in a great river at that same Vārāṇasī. Then through the force of karma he will be cast out onto dry land, and that great body will be devoured by venomous serpents, crows, water-birds, dogs, leopards, bears, jackals, and the like, as well as by various other creatures. Then again through the force of karma a body will arise and be consumed, and so it will continue for three years. Then again, having died, he will be born into seven houses and experience the sufferings of Jambudvīpa: he will be born into a house of lepers, into a house of the poor, into a house of slaves, into a house of butchers, into a house of low birth, into a house of outcasts, and into a house of the blind, experiencing suffering for sixty years. Having experienced those sufferings, he will then die and transmigrate, and in the sixteen great hells he will experience suffering for eighty-four eons. Lord of the gods, such are the great sufferings he will experience. Moreover, if even after a hundred such rebirths he obtains a human body, it will be a body marked by poverty, incomplete limbs, feeble wisdom, illiteracy, and separation from the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha.

He will be scorned by all the world, perpetually tormented by thirst and hunger, short-lived, and beset by many illnesses.

Then Śakra, the Lord of Gods (Indra, king of the gods), having heard this dire account concerning the divine son Ratnagarbha Vimāla, was deeply terrified and distressed in the presence of the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, I have lost all hope. There is no refuge for me."

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of Gods, there is a great antidote to the punishment of the Lord of Death — therefore do not give up hope. In future times, at the moment of death, it will bring those sentient beings a peaceful passing. They will be fully liberated from all rebirths in the hells and in the animal realm. By mere recollection, all obscurations will be purified. Their lives

will be long. They will obtain utterly pure bodies."

Then Śakra, the Lord of Gods, together with the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and the Great Lord (Śiva), pressed their palms together, bowed toward the Blessed One, and spoke to him thus: "Blessed One, please increase our hope. Blessed One, please protect all the gods. Blessed One, please liberate all the worlds of living beings. Blessed One, please pacify the fear of death. Blessed One, please remove the unbearable suffering of the hell-beings. Blessed One, please summon Yama, the King of Dharma (the lord of the dead). Blessed One, please grant relief to the sentient beings of the four-continent world-system. Blessed One, please look upon the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods. Blessed One, please seal all the Tathāgatas of the ten directions throughout all the world-systems of the ten directions with the great mudrā of the Tathāgatas' primordial wisdom. Please bestow blessing through the blessing of the Tathāgatas. Blessed One, out of your compassion for us, please expound the great antidote. Sugata (the Well-Gone One, an epithet of the Buddha), please speak."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, having taken to heart what was thus requested, entered into meditative absorption called Seeing All Aspects in All Ways. The instant he entered that absorption, a ray of light called All Aspects emerged from the center of his crown protrusion, illuminating all directions, and it remained in the sky like a jeweled parasol. The Blessed One smiled and, gazing upon Śakra, the Lord of Gods, declared to him these words:

"Lord of Gods, receive this dhāraṇī mantra called Omnipresently Illuminating Crown Radiance, Stainless — the essence and samaya (sacred pledge) of all the Tathāgatas, Gazing on All Aspects. This mudrā has been spoken and rejoiced over by as many Tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in sixty-two hundred-thousand-million Ganges rivers. By merely seeing or hearing this dhāraṇī mantra, one will be fully liberated from all sins, obscurations, the hells, the animal realm, and every fear of the lower destinies. All karmic obscurations from the past will be utterly destroyed, and all hells will be obliterated. Just as fire burns grass and wind swiftly scatters the ashes, so too will all the sins accumulated over former lives be burned. Just as when rain descends and the water that falls upon the mountains sweeps away all the dust and filth upon the earth, so likewise by merely seeing and hearing this dhāraṇī, sins will be cleansed."

Just as gold refined by fire
becomes fit to be worked and beaten with ease,
so likewise by mere recitation
the body is purified — of this there is no doubt.

Just as when the sun has risen
its rays blaze forth in all directions,
so too whoever holds this dhāraṇī
will find their very body made luminous and beautiful.

Just as a fish cast out on dry land
turns and thrashes, parted from the water, at the gate of death,
but then is thrown back into the water once more
and lives there, thriving and flourishing again —
so too by mere recollection of this dhāraṇī
people's lives are reversed and restored.

O Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra, king of the gods), listen now: here is the
dhāraṇī mantra to be taught.

Namas sarva-tathāgatānāṃ. Om mahācintāmaṇi-jvalana, sāgaragambhire,
ākarṣaya ākarṣaya, āyundhara āyundhara, sandhara sandhara, kṣaṇa-kṣaṇa,
kṣeṇi-kṣeṇi, kṣunu-kṣunu, sarva-tathāgata-mahāsamaya, tiṣṭha tiṣṭha,
mahābhuvana-sāgara, saṃśodhaya, māṃ sarvasatvāṃś ca, bhagavati,
sarva-pāpaṃ vimala, jaya jaya, jayalabhe, sphuṭa sphuṭa, sphoṭaya sphoṭaya,
vigata-āvaraṇi, bhaya-haraṇi, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, mṛtyudaṇḍadhare, abhayaprade,
uṣṇīṣa-vyavalokite, samanta-muṣe, samanta-vyavalokite, mahāmāyi,
mahāpāśadhare, amogha-vimale, ākarṣaya ākarṣaya, ākāḍhaya ākāḍhaya,
bhara bhara, sambhara sambhara, indriya-viśodhani, bhūṣita-bhujе,
mahāmudrā-vilokite, jaya jaya, siddhe siddhe, buddha buddha, bodhani
bodhani, saṃbodhani saṃbodhani, śodhani śodhani, saṃśodhani saṃśodhani,
viśodhani viśodhani, hara hara, mama sarva-pāpaṃ,
sarva-tathāgata-kula-bhujе, samaya-tiṣṭhe, prasaratu mama puṇye,
vinaśyantu pāpaṃ, sarva-kilbiṣa-hare, maṇi-viśuddhe, śodhaya vimale,
vikāśita-padme, gabhacanta-bhujе, ṣaṭpāramitā-paripūraṇi,
sarva-tathāgatoṣṇīṣa-vilokite svāhā,
sarva-tathāgata-guhya-adhiṣṭhāna-adhiṣṭhite svāhā, āyur-dade svāhā,
puṇya-dade svāhā, puṇya-vilokite svāhā, puṇya-avalokite svāhā, mṛtyudaṇḍe
svāhā, yamadaṇḍe svāhā, yamadūte svāhā, saṃharaṇi svāhā, sambharaṇi
svāhā, sandhāraṇi svāhā, pratisaraṇi svāhā, ojovatī svāhā, tejovatī svāhā,

jayavatī svāhā, sarva-tathāgata-mudrā-adhiṣṭhāna-adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

O Śakra, lord of the gods, teach this dhāraṇī mantra to the god's son Ratnagarbha Vimāla. By doing so, you will bring that god's son long-lasting benefit and happiness.

Write out this dhāraṇī mantra — which is the Tathāgata Sarvanivāraṇaviṣkambhin (the "All-Illuminating Crown Protrusion Free of Defilement, Perceiving All Entrances"), the essence and sacred commitment of all Tathāgatas — and place it inside a stūpa. Whether the stūpa is new or old and in need of repair, place it within. Offer incense and unguents as well, and recite the mantra essence of the dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times with mindfulness, meditating upon it one hundred and eight times. Each day, recollect it three times during the day and three times at night.

Then, when the sun has risen, face the eastern direction, create a maṇḍala of incense, and scatter flowers toward the sun. Burn incense of aloeswood and turushka resin, make prostrations to all the Tathāgatas, and recite it one hundred and eight times.

If this mantra essence is written, inserted into one hundred and eight constructed stūpas, and placed upon a maṇḍala, it will be as though the body-relics and sacred remains of Tathāgatas as numerous as ninety-nine hundred thousand billion grains of sand of the Ganges River have been placed within each and every one of those stūpas. It will also become the very essence of sacred relics. Write out this essence and insert it.

Oṃ namas traya-dhvikānāṃ.

Sarva tathāgata hṛdaya garbhe jvala jvala. Dharmadhātu garbhe saṃbharam ā āyuḥ. Saṃśodhaya saṃśodhaya. Mama sarva pāpaṃ. Sarva tathāgata samantoṣṇīṣa vimāla viśuddhe. Hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Aṃ vaṃ saṃ jaḥ svāhā.

This text, called Radiant Light of the Uṣṇīṣa, Pure and All-Entering, is the very heart-essence of all Tathāgatas of the three times. If one pays reverent homage to it and performs the stūpa rites, a life that is drawing to its close will be turned back, and life will be purified and made long. Even if death and transmigration do occur, one will cast off the body just as a serpent sheds its skin, and through the equality of fortune will journey to the world-realm of Bliss. One will not experience the suffering of death. Henceforth one will never again experience the sensation of dying. Henceforth one will never again take birth in hell, among animals, in the realm of the Lord of Death, or in any lower

destiny. If even the sound of the word "hell-being" will never again reach one's ears, it goes without saying that the ripening of such karmic results is simply impossible — there is no basis for it whatsoever.

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, having received this mantra from the Blessed One, departed together with the divine son Ratnavisuddha at the break of dawn and returned to his own abode. Following the scriptural instructions as declared by the Tathāgata, and performing the stūpa rites in their proper sequence, he then also performed the recitation rite. The very moment he had done so, the divine son Ratnavisuddha was pacified of all suffering and freed from all misdeeds. His body became purified, his complexion became like the color of gold, and his hair and eyes became like deep blue beryl. He beheld all the Tathāgatas directly before him, and from the expanse of space the Tathāgatas gave forth the words "Excellent! Excellent!" Then, seeing that the divine son had attained a body free of obscurations, Śakra was struck with great wonder and filled with great joy, and he exclaimed with fervent utterance: "How marvelous — the buddhas! How marvelous — the mantra! How marvelous — the Dharma! I pay homage, I pay homage, to the Blessed One the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, who reveals the fruit immediately, whose compassion is supremely great, who is like a wish-fulfilling jewel." He uttered these words of fervent praise again and again.

Then that divine son returned to his own abode, took up divine flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, and various unguents, took also divine garments, robes, and ornaments, and together with all his attendants and retinue, divine maidens, the host of gods, Śakra, lord of the gods, and the rest, he set out for the Tuṣita realm. Going to where the Blessed One was and arriving there, he made great offerings to the Blessed One, circumambulated him a hundred thousand times, and then sat down in the very presence of the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), and Vajrapāṇi, great lord of the yakṣas, joined their palms and bowed toward where the Blessed One was, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, through what cause will there arise for the divine son Ratnavisuddha karmic maturations that are unbearable and exceedingly fierce?"

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent, noble ones! Noble ones, you have asked well. Therefore, listen and I shall explain. Vajrapāṇi, in a time gone by, in a past age, in the southern region there was a city called Vistīrṇa. In that

place there lived a brahmin named Vimala — learned, refined, clear-minded, of settled intellect, handsome and beautiful in appearance, pleasing to behold, of splendid and excellent complexion —"

— faithful, of virtuous intention, and a speaker of sacred learning. He dwelt there continually recollecting and meditating upon this queen of vidyā-mantras (dhāraṇī), and he desired the welfare of all sentient beings. Now in that very same city there lived a householder named Prabhāvara — wealthy, of great riches, of great possessions, with many servants and attendants. This householder had no faith whatsoever, and instead placed his faith in the tīrthikas. Though the brahmin repeatedly proclaimed this queen of vidyā-mantras together with its essence-syllables to that householder, the householder generated no mind of faith toward it. On the contrary, he thought to himself: "I shall hack this brahmin to pieces, toss him away as one discards burnt fish and turtle, and stuff his mouth with filth." The very moment he conceived this thought, the householder was struck by skin disease and leprosy. He then died at the appointed hour of death, experiencing great suffering in the feeling at the moment of passing. After dying, he was born in the great hell Avīci, and there he experienced the feeling of suffering for the measure of an aeon. After dying and passing away from there, he experienced suffering for an aeon among fish, pigs, and turtles. Dying and passing away from there, he was born in the hell called the Pitch-Black, and there too he experienced great suffering for the measure of an aeon. After dying and passing away from there, he was born blind in a household in that very same city. Being blind, he went about begging from one place to another, and one day he came to a temple. There was a monk dwelling there, a monk who abided in compassion. Seeing him, that monk treated him with loving-kindness, gave him food, and also proclaimed this queen of vidyā-mantras. Upon hearing this dhāraṇī-mantra, the blind man recalled his past lives. He remembered that brahmin and, reflecting upon him, thought: "Alas, I have committed an unbearable act," and he became filled with remorse and shame. When the hour of his death came, by the power of this dhāraṇī-mantra he was born among the gods of the Thirty-Three, and within a great celestial palace, surrounded by throngs of divine maidens, he came to experience great divine enjoyments. Now if you should suspect and doubt, thinking that the householder who became blind at that time and in that age was someone other than yourself — do not look upon it so. It was none other than the divine son Ratnavisuddha himself. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, one must be

restrained by the three vows. Vajrapāṇi, it was because of those deeds that he experienced such karmic maturation — a feeling of suffering such as this. This divine son will experience this final karmic fruit of his actions until the very end, right up to the seat of awakening. And Vajrapāṇi, if you should suspect and doubt, thinking that the brahmin Vimāla who lived at that time and in that age was someone other than yourself — do not look upon it so. Vajrapāṇi, it was you yourself. And the monk who proclaimed this dhāraṇī-mantra to the blind man — that was none other than Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, who at that time and in that age had become a monk.

Then the great multitude of the divine retinue, having heard this account of past events, became filled with wonder. Overcome with joy, they burst into tremendous sounds of celebration and acclaim, and exclaimed again and again: "Marvelous! The power of this vidyā-mantra of the Tathāgata's sacred pledge is like a wish-fulfilling jewel!" Then from within that retinue, twenty-two thousand divine sons became irreversible. One hundred billion divine daughters were separated from female faculties, and male faculties arose in them, and they abided in irreversibility itself.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great lord-commander of the yakṣas, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this queen of vidyā-mantras, this dhāraṇī, is of great power and great benefit. Blessed One, please teach the ritual of accomplishment by which, in the future, in the time yet to come, sentient beings may be benefited and brought to happiness, and through which they may be fully liberated from the realms of hell-beings and animals."

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to the benefits of this dhāraṇī-mantra and to its ritual of accomplishment. In the future, in the time yet to come, whether a son of good family or a daughter of good family, a monk or a nun, a layman or a laywoman, one should recall this queen of vidyā-mantras in a single moment. One should circumambulate a stūpa that contains relics, the very essence of relics, or the relics of a Tathāgata. One should likewise recall these two — this wish-fulfilling jewel, this precious gem — in that same moment. By doing so, one will plant roots of virtue with respect to Tathāgatas as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges River, multiplied by a hundred thousand billions. One will come to be endowed with great merit. The karmic obscurations of the five acts of immediate retribution will be completely purified. One will be fully liberated from the lower realms — the realms of hell-beings, the realm of animals, and the evil destinies of Yama's world. One's life will become long. Just as a snake sheds its skin, one

will shed the body and, by reason of equal fortune, will travel to the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. From then on one will not be stained by the impurities of dwelling in a womb; wherever one is born, in whatever birth, one will arise by miraculous birth, born from a lotus. In all lifetimes one will remember one's former lives. Always one will have the wish to behold all Tathāgatas. All one's aspirations will be completely fulfilled just as one wishes.

If one wishes to perform the ritual, one should bathe and don fresh garments. One should make a square maṇḍala of incense. One should write the essence-mantra on birch bark. One should place five stūpas. This vidyā-mantra too should be inserted inside the stūpas. Four of the stūpas are to be placed at the four corners, and one is to be placed in the centre of the maṇḍala. One should plant a wooden pole and hang a red banner from it. One should scatter flowers. One should place five full vases. From the four corners one should perform fumigation with incense of costus, aloeswood, sandalwood, and bdellium. One should place four vessels for fragrant offering-water. These two — this wish-fulfilling jewel, this precious gem — should be recited one hundred and eight times. Reciting the essence-mantra, one should circumambulate the maṇḍala one hundred and eight times. Those afflicted by illness, or harmed, or gravely ill, or whose lifespan is exhausted, or who are frightened by untimely death, or who are terrified by kings or by hostile armies, or who desire a child — these persons should be made to face directly toward the maṇḍala. One should fan them with five peacock feathers. One should make offerings at the maṇḍala of the stūpa. If this ritual is performed even once, one will be freed from the karmic obscurations accumulated over a hundred thousand aeons and become without obscuration. One will be fully liberated from all illness, all mental afflictions, the realm of hell-beings, the realm of animals, all the evil destinies of Yama's world, and all fears. From all worldly and transcendent suffering, obscurations, misdeeds, and"

all harmful forces accumulated from one life to the next will be utterly destroyed, all the way until one reaches the heart of awakening. Even a life that has been exhausted will be renewed and lengthened. Even a body long wasted away by illness and reduced to mere flesh will be made completely whole again. The body will become utterly purified. Aspirations will be fulfilled just as one wishes. From that point forward, one will never again see the suffering at the door of the Lord of Death. Just as a snake sheds its skin, one will cast off the body and, by virtue of equal fortune, will go to the world-realm

of Sukhāvatī. In whatever birth one takes, one will be born from a lotus. Everywhere one will be adorned with every adornment. In all one's births, one will remember past lives.

If, in accordance with the recitation rite of this dhāraṇī, one recites it twenty-one times in each of the three periods of the day, every day, that person will be fully liberated from all sinful obscurations and all mental afflictions. If one completes a full year of recitation in accordance with the rite, one will attain the meditative absorption called Luminous Light from All Directions Without Fear. One will behold all the Tathāgatas in all the buddha-fields of the ten directions. One will attain a thoroughly purified body called Stainless Pure Blazing Splendor. One will attain a thoroughly purified life. One will generate roots of virtue in relation to as many Tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in eighty-two hundred-thousand-ten-thousand Ganges rivers. In all the lives that pass from one to the next, one will become utterly purified. To whatever buddha-field one wishes to go, one will go there. Just as a snake sheds its skin, one will cast off the body and, by virtue of equal fortune, will be born in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. One will not see the door of the Lord of Death, and one will know all things as if in a dream.

On the eighth, or the fourteenth, or the fifteenth day of the month, if one recites these two dhāraṇī mantras of the great precious wish-fulfilling jewel one hundred and eight times, and then circumambulates a stūpa containing relics, the mere act of recitation will instantly cause a sound to arise from the stūpa, bestowing the word "Excellent!" Instantly one will be freed from all sinful obscurations, all mental afflictions, the defilements of attachment, aversion, and delusion, as well as miserliness and jealousy. The body will be free of stain and utterly purified. All those men, women, boys, or girls with whom one has spoken will likewise be freed from their misdeeds. If one speaks these words to a being born in the animal realm, that being will be fully liberated from every state of animal birth. If one speaks them to any gathering of birds, every bird in that gathering will be fully liberated. Even if one speaks them to dogs, frogs, snakes, cats, mice, or various other living creatures, all of them will be fully liberated.

If one recites the mantra twenty-one times over sand and then scatters it in a charnel ground, whatever bones that sand touches — whatever hell-beings were born in those various hells — will be fully liberated from those states and will be born in the higher realms. Upon the bodies of those born in the higher realms, a rain of flowers will fall. All the predatory beasts and various birds

that frequent that charnel ground will also go to a fortunate destiny. If the sand is scattered on a mountain, the wild animals of the mountain and all the birds that roam there will go to a fortunate destiny.

If one recites the mantra of Uṣṇīṣavijayā (the Radiant Crown Protrusion, Pure and Unstained, Essence of the Tathāgatas of the Three Times) one hundred thousand times, then even those who have committed the five deeds of immediate retribution, who have fallen into the Avīci hell and are being burned and tormented, will be fully liberated from that state at once. If one recites it one hundred thousand times, then even one who has been led away with a rope around the neck will be immediately turned back from the realm of Yama, the Lord of Death, and fully freed from that great terror. All the hells of sentient beings will become completely pacified and will be destroyed — of this there is no doubt. Yama, the Dharma King, will be as a servant, sitting in attendance. One will cast off the body as if shedding the skin of a snake, or as if traveling the path of dhyāna, and will joyfully depart to the world-system of Sukhāvatī. One will no longer behold the suffering of death.

If it is written one hundred thousand times and placed inside a stūpa, all the stūpas of the hundred thousand copies will blaze with light. The composer will also blaze with light. One will assuredly and immediately become irreversible. One will abide on the tenth ground. One will give rise to roots of virtue before a number of Blessed Tathāgatas equal to ninety-nine hundred thousand myriads of koṭis of grains of sand in the Ganges, and will receive their prophecies. Thereafter, if it is placed inside one great stūpa and a parasol is raised above it, it shall be called the Stūpa of One Hundred Thousand, the Essence of the Relics of the Tathāgatas of the Three Times. All who perform these acts there will become irreversible. They will perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Even those who belong to the animal realm, and moreover whatever various species of living creatures pass through that place, will also become irreversible. If even one's shadow falls upon it one will be fully liberated — how much more need be said of those who offer it great veneration? The qualities and benefits of this cannot be described in words.

Then the great chief of the yakṣas, Vajrapāṇi, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great Lord Maheśvara, the divine sons dwelling in the Tuṣita heaven, Śakra (Indra) and the rest of the divine sons of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the divine son Ratnagarbhavimala, and all of them — all went to

where the Blessed One was, and having arrived they circumambulated the Blessed One three times, then bowing with joined palms toward the Blessed One, they addressed the Blessed One in these words: Blessed One, this great and powerful dhāraṇī mantra is like a precious wish-fulfilling jewel — rare to see, rare to hear. Blessed One, we have gathered here together, and in future times, in future ages, we will uphold this precious wish-fulfilling jewel. We will spread it widely. We will proclaim it to all sentient beings. For the sake of the great sentient beings who hold it, we will follow after them and protect, guard, and shelter them without interruption and without cease. We will nurture them as if they were our own children.

The Blessed One declared: Excellent, excellent, friends! Do just as you have said. I entrust to you this queen of awareness-mantras, this precious wish-fulfilling jewel.

Here ends the noble dhāraṇī called "The Radiant Uṣṇīṣa Free from Defilement, the Ray of Light that Enters from All Directions — a Vision of the Commitments and the Essence of All Tathāgatas."

Translated from Sanskrit by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Śīlendrabodhi, together with the great editorial translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, who revised and established the final text.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "सुद्धावसा देवसंमेलनं" literally means "a great assembly of the gods of the Long-Life Heaven," referring to Śuddhāvāsa or a similar long-lived divine realm. The identification is not entirely certain from context alone, but the rendering given is standard.

The expression "वीर्यव्रतसंनिभं" rendered as "courageous-advance absorption" is a standard dhāraṇī-text epithet for a specific samādhi; the precise technical referent within the abhidharma classification system is not identified in this passage alone.

- The phrase rendered "your death may pass away on its own terms" translates a petition that the divine son's death come about through liberation rather than by a self-willed act and rather than leading to a lower rebirth. The Tibetan is slightly elliptical here; the rendering follows the most natural doctrinal sense given the context.

The heaven "तुषिता" is Tuṣita in Sanskrit, a name well known to listeners, so it is glossed parenthetically as "the Joyful Heaven (Tuṣita)" on this occurrence.

- The phrase rendered "divine yakṣa-chief Comet-Face" (lha'i gnod sbyin gyi gtso bo skar mda'i gdong) names a yakṣa leader whose epithet literally means "arrow-star face" or "meteor face," here rendered as "Comet-Face" for natural speech. The identity and role of this figure is specific to this sūtra's narrative context.

The sequence of rebirths described — sow in a cesspit, turtle in a waterless desert, great fish cast onto land, and then seven human births of degraded circumstance — is a karmic biography narrated by the Buddha as a warning, a common literary device in Vinaya-adjacent

and dhāranī literature.

- The name "Ratnagarbha Vimala" renders रत्नगर्भविमल, literally "Stainless Jewel-Essence." This appears to be the personal name of a divine son mentioned in the preceding untranslated portion; the rendering keeps it as a proper name consistent with the sūtra context.

The phrase ལྷོ་ཁྱུང་ལྷོ་ཁྱུང་ལྷོ་ཁྱུང་ལྷོ་ཁྱུང་ལྷོ་ཁྱུང་ — literally "the world-system of the four-continent region" — refers to the standard Buddhist cosmological unit of a world with four continents arrayed around Mount Meru. Rendered as "four-continent world-system" for clarity.

- The epithet of the Tathāgata rendered here as "All-Illuminating Crown Protrusion Free of Defilement, Perceiving All Entrances" corresponds to Sarvanivāraṇaṣkambhin in related traditions, but the Tibetan phrase here — literally "the crown protrusion free of defilement that illuminates as it enters from all directions" — is a descriptive epithet of the dhāraṇī itself rather than a straightforward proper name, and may be a compressed reference to Uṣṇīṣavijaya or a related usnīsa dhāraṇī corpus. The identification is contextually reasonable but not certain.

The Sanskrit mantra text is rendered as it appears in the Tibetan transliteration. Some syllables show minor orthographic variation from other known recensions of this dhāraṇī; these have not been normalized, as the Tibetan transliteration is the primary witness here.

The name "Ratnagarbha Vimala" for the god's son reflects the Tibetan "lha'i bu nor bu'i snying po dri ma med pa," literally "the stainless essence of jewels, son of the gods." This appears to be a proper name of the divine youth who is the recipient of the teaching.

- The passage shifts between mantra syllables in Sanskrit transcription and narrative prose in Tibetan. The mantra lines are rendered as transliterated Sanskrit exactly as they appear, which is standard for liturgical texts of this kind.

The phrase rendered "the Tuṣita realm" translates dga' ldan gyi gnas, literally "the abode of Tuṣita," the heaven associated with Maitreya and, in this context, with the assembly around the Blessed One.

The closing description of the brahmin Vimāla is left mid-sentence as the Tibetan passage ends there; the translation faithfully reproduces this open ending.

- The term translated as "queen of vidyā-mantras" renders rig sngags kyi rgyal mo, a standard Tibetan equivalent of Sanskrit vidyārājñī, a class of powerful dhāraṇī; "essence-syllables" renders snying po (Skt. hṛdaya), referring to the heart or seed-syllable portion of the mantra. The phrase "the three vows" refers to the prātimokṣa, bodhisattva, and tantric vows, the standard Tibetan threefold schema of saṃvara. The passage concerning the divine daughters receiving male faculties reflects a recurrent Indian Buddhist motif in which gender transformation is treated as a sign of spiritual advancement toward irreversibility; no doctrinal gloss has been inserted into the body text.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, breaking off after the enumeration of worldly and transcendent suffering and misdeeds. The translation reflects this open ending faithfully; the following passage will complete the sentence.

The term rendered "birch bark" for 桦皮 reflects the standard identification of this writing material in ritual manuals of this genre, though the term can occasionally refer to other smooth-surfaced materials. This reading is well supported and not significantly uncertain.

- The meditative absorption name rendered as "Luminous Light from All Directions Without Fear" follows the Tibetan literally: "འོད་གསལ་རྒྱ་མཁོན་ཀློང་སྤྲིན་ལྷུང་སྐྱོབ་པའི་སྙིང་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡེ་སྟོན་ཆེན་པོ།" The phrase is an unusual compound and its Sanskrit original is uncertain; the rendering keeps the literal sense. Similarly, "Stainless Pure Blazing Splendor" renders "འཕྲོ་མེ་ལྗང་ལྷུང་ལྷན་པོའི་སྙིང་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡེ་སྟོན་ཆེན་པོ།," a title whose Sanskrit equivalent is not

recoverable from context alone.

- The phrase rendered "cast off the body as if traveling the path of dhyāna" follows the Tibetan closely: the body is shed like a snake's skin, and the simile of dhyāna's path suggests the effortless, subtle transition out of embodied existence. The exact force of the dhyāna simile here is unusual and may reflect a specific transmission; it is not smoothed over in the translation.

The divine son "Ratnagarbhavimāla" renders Tibetan *nor bu'i snying po dri ma med pa* literally as "Unstained Essence of the Jewel," which is a recognized divine son figure in this class of *dhāraṇī* literature.

- The title phrase "*kun nas sgor 'jug pa'i 'od zer gtsug tor dri ma med par snang ba*" is dense and could be parsed in more than one way; the rendering here follows the most natural syntactic reading, taking "*kun nas sgor 'jug pa'i 'od zer*" as a modifier of the *uṣṇīṣa* epithet rather than as a separate title element. The colophon attribution to Jinamitra, Śīlendrabodhi, and Yeshé Dé is a standard trio associated with several canonical translations of this period.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.